Action Buddy

Your first step to a clearer mind

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We usually tell ourselves that if we aren't getting our work done, we're just being lazy or we lack willpower. But for most of us, that's not actually the case.

The real issue isn't a lack of ambition. It’s that our brains are stuck running three invisible scripts on repeat. These are the mental blocks that stop us from even starting, no matter how much we want to succeed.

OVERWHELM

When a project feels like a single, massive task rather than a series of steps, the brain effectively freezes. It isn't a lack of desire, it’s a **lack of a clear next step**

THE INNER CRITIC

When we are overly critical of our own output, starting a task feels like a risk to our self-esteem. To **avoid the discomfort of failing,** we simply don't begin

AVOIDANCE

We prioritize the immediate relief of a distraction over the long-term benefit of the work. We’re essentially **trading our long-term goals for short-term relief**

Sara, 23

Background

- Third-year uni student
- Two CCAs: dance crew (weekly rehearsals) + social media lead for health volunteer group
- Exam seasons hit hard with weekly mugging/rewriting notes

Daily Struggles

- Late-night study > CCA practice > crash with racing thoughts cycle
- Feels burnt out but doesn't know how to regulate emotions
- No time for therapy; meditation apps feel inauthentic

Stress Triggers

- Exams (memorizing drug interactions)
- CCA deadlines (choreo videos)
- Family pressure for pharma career stability

Goals

- Quick daily reset to sort thoughts and regain focus
- Specific next actions, not vague advice

Pain Points

- Overwhelmed by "just breathe" platitudes
- Needs concrete steps like "log stress trigger > match with similar experience"

Insights

Gen Z Singaporeans (ages 16-24) show the highest multi-platform usage, averaging **8.2 platforms per user (Ngu, 2025)**

Preference of Video Content Platforms - Tiktok (Ngu, 2025)

- Spends approximately 3 hours daily on social media, with TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube commanding the majority of their attention.
- Over 84% prefers consuming video content
- Tiktok most used platform - 34% of total users are Gen Zs (highest percentage)

Preference for personalised experience (DeBrusk & Kreacic, 2023)

- Personalization online is one of the main reasons they spend so much time on social media platforms, as **56% of Gen Z** say that relatable content that fulfills personal interests are their primary reason for liking social media content
- Customisation isn't just about owning a one-of-a-kind item; it's about the experience of creating it. Gen Zs prioritise experiences over possessions (Carballo, 2025)

Insights

Intentional Curation over Passive Consumption (Strang, 2022)

- Gen Z views digital platforms as fluid ecosystems rather than fixed utilities.
- They exercise their freedom of choice by migrating toward spaces that offer immediate "platform relevance" and emotional alignment, favouring apps that adapt to their shifting moods and needs.

Customisation as a Standard for Retention (Schade, 2016)

- A "one-size-fits-all" UI is a point of friction.
- The ability to toggle preferences and reorganise layouts provide cognitive comfort.
- Transforms an app from a mere tool into a personalised environment, driving deeper engagement.

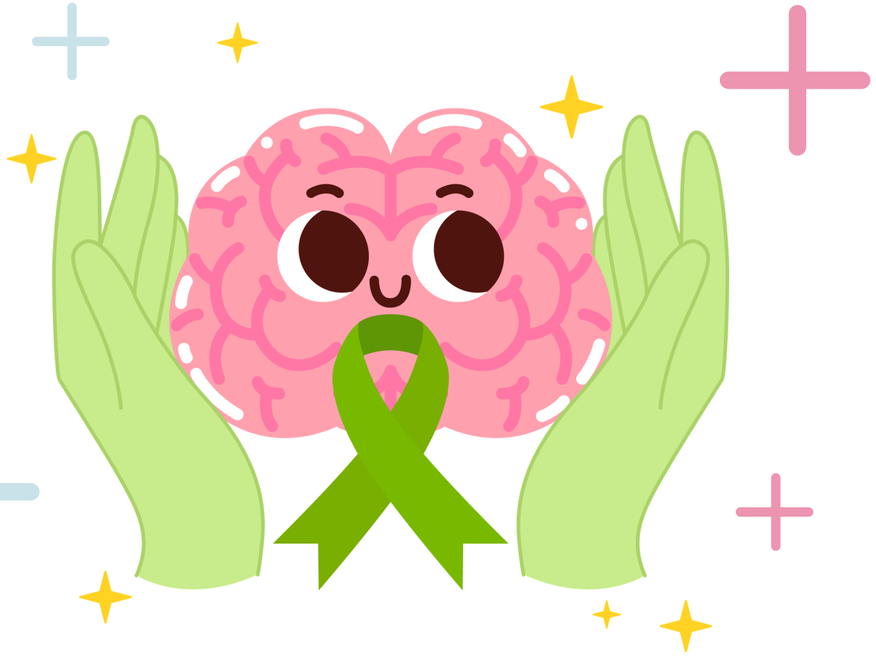
Validation Through "Digital Fingerprinting" (Salesforce, 2026)

- Hyper-personalisation is a tool for identity signalling.
- By allowing users to tweak aesthetics and filter for hyper-niche interests, a brand moves from being a generic provider to a "co-creator".
- Validates the user’s sense of self and fosters a feeling of personal ownership.

Our idea

Clarity is the first step.

Overwhelm often stems from a lack of direction. Action Buddy helps you identify your primary hurdles, turning complex tasks into manageable, actionable steps.



How it works

Deliver a clear, visually-driven message across multiple touchpoints.

- **Billboard Concept:** Visualizing the transition from overwhelm to clarity.
- **Campaign Idea:** Personality Quiz to identify user archetypes & suggests customisable journaling tools.
- **Social Pairing Idea:** TikTok video to drive brand discovery.

Billboard

Mirror Hook technique:

- Broad information → Audience Resonance
- More personal and reflective

Visual First Execution:

- Invites viewers to identify with the scene instead of telling them what to feel

Single Message & Feeling:

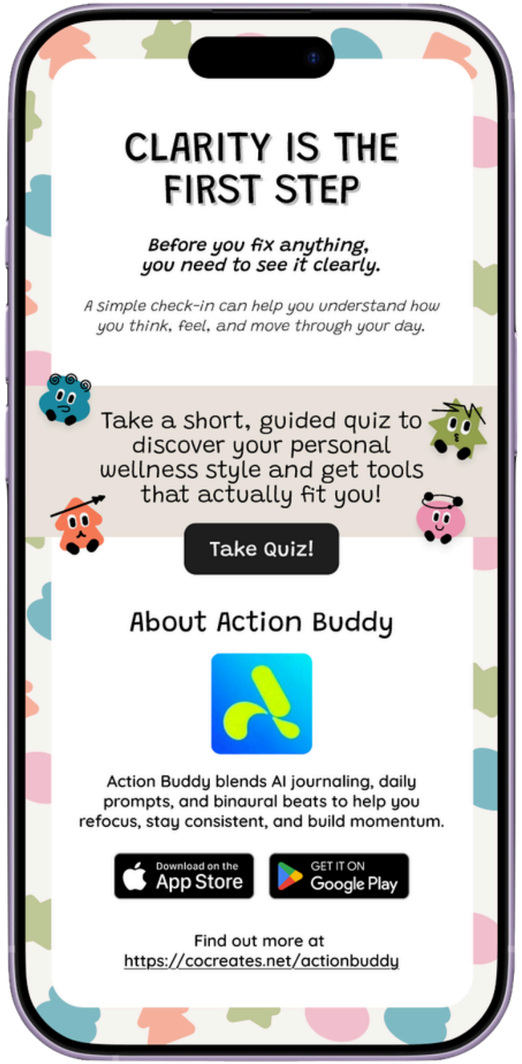
- Don’t try to explain the whole app, focuses on feelings of being overwhelmed & promise of relatability
- Less complex, creates a clear focus which encourages next steps

Campaign Idea

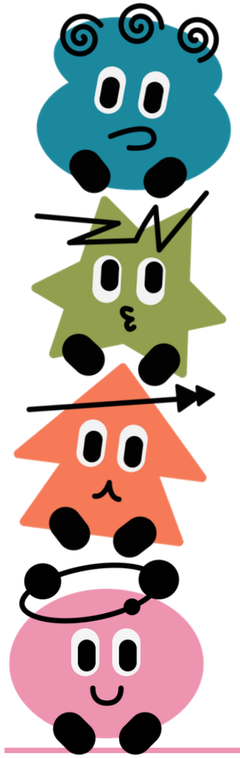
Personality/Archetype Quiz:

- **Landing Page**
  - Acts as a touchpoint after scanning the QR code on the billboard.
  - Entices users to take the first step on their journey towards mental clarity.

- **Call-to-action:**
  - “Clarity is the first step” as a reason to discover their archetype.
  - Features brief information about the Action Buddy app along with download buttons.



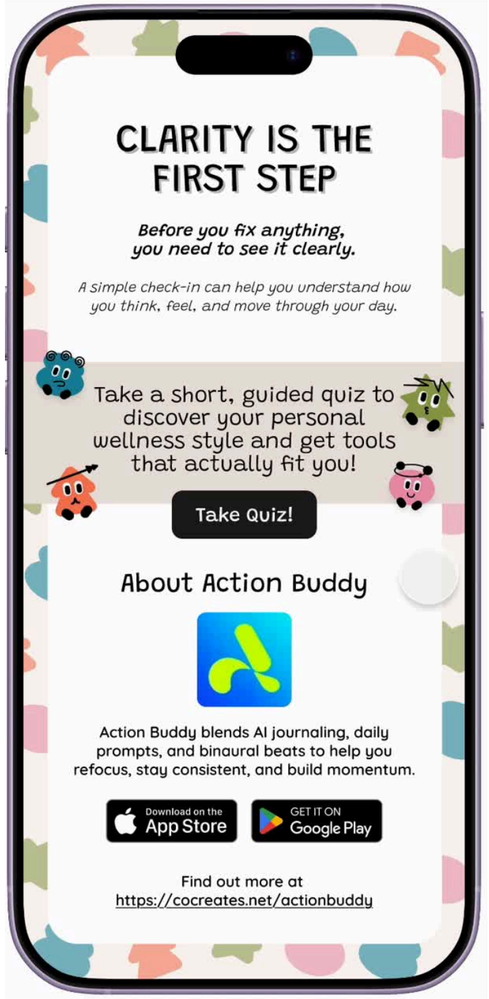
Campaign Idea

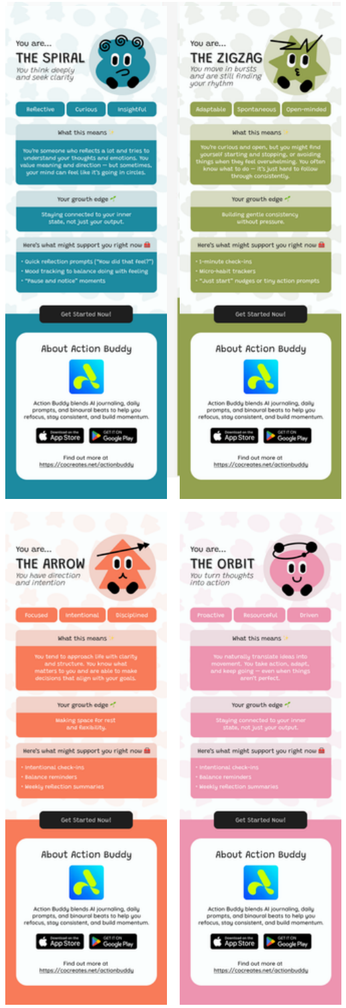


Personality/Archetype Quiz:

- **What Shape Is Your Mind In?**
  - 7-question quiz to discover your mindset/executive functioning style.
  - Based on archetype, recommends app features designed to fit the way one processes and expresses their thoughts.

- **Recommendations for the app:**
  - Users should be able to personalise their dashboard and reorder key features to prioritise the features recommended for their archetype.





Social Pairing Idea

Format:

- TikTok Short Form Video
- Uses a relatable, day-in-the-life narrative

Key Feature Highlight:

- **Inner Council: Buddy Chat**
- An AI-guided conversation tool that encourages guided self-reflection
- Helps users organise thoughts and reach their own conclusions

Impact:

- Supports mental wellness in daily life
- Helps users manage stress through clarity
- Positions AI as a support tool, not a decision-maker

Why this matters

Benefits of changes + feasibility + anticipate concerns

Overcome Mental Blocks
Action Buddy moves users from a state of "freezing" into taking clear, manageable steps.

Drive Gen Z Engagement
Archetype quiz and customizable layouts fulfills high preference for relatable, personalized environments that foster ownership

Feasibility
Our Campaign leverages billboard, quiz, and TikTok to turn Gen Z's daily social habits into a frictionless path for app adoption and mental clarity.

Maintaining User Autonomy
Users may become too dependent on the AI, feeling they have less control over their own decisions.

Thank You

Any Questions for us?

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